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MOHAMMAD BIN RASHID TOURS MINA AL HAMRIYA

■ His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, visited Mina Al Hamriya yesterday to review progress on the port's ongoing development and its expanding role in advancing regional and global trade. During the tour, Shaikh Mohammad was briefed on the port's strategic role in supporting the UAE's food security and facilitating trade across the Arabian Gulf, particularly in perishables and livestock. Among the key announcements was Shaikh Mohammad's approval of a major new project: the construction of a 700-metre quay with a 12-metre draft, enabling the port to accommodate larger vessels and significantly increase its cargo-handling capacity.

UAE passport 8th most powerful

Country has climbed
34 places over the
last 10 years

DUBAI
BY ANUPAM VARMA
Online Editor

Mid-year passport rankings have just been released, and the UAE continues to be a standout among the top risers, shooting up 34 places over the last 10 years from 42nd to 8th place, making it the only big riser to break into the top 10 in the ranking.

The UAE moved up from 11th in 2024 with its passport now providing visa-free access to 184 destinations.

Singapore has continued to

184

destinations to which
UAE passport gives
visa-free access

hold the crown as the world's
most powerful passport.

The country's passport allows visa-free access to 193 destinations out of 227 globally, according to the latest Henley Passport Index.

Japan, South Korea second

The second spot is shared by Japan and South Korea, each granting their citizens access to 190 destinations visa-free.

Seven EU passports share 3rd place – Denmark, Finland, France, Germany, Ireland, Italy, and Spain, all with access to 189 destinations. Meanwhile, another set of European countries, with visa-free entry to 188 destinations, are joint 4th – Austria, Belgium, Luxembourg, Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, and Sweden. New Zealand, the only nation to challenge the regional dominance, ties in 5th place with Greece and Switzerland.

India has recorded the largest jump in ranking over the past six months, climbing eight places from 85th to 77th. Meanwhile, Saudi Arabia has made the biggest gain in visa-free access, adding four destinations since January.

Over 32,000 residency law violations registered in UAE

ICP steps up
inspections on
residency breaches

ABU DHABI
BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

The Federal Authority for Identity, Citizenship, Customs, and Port Security (ICP) has apprehended over 32,000 individuals for violating the Foreign Entry and Residency Law between January and the end of June 2025.

These arrests were made as part of nationwide inspection campaigns under the initiative "Towards a Safer Society", aimed at promoting compliance with laws governing the

residency and employment of
foreigners in the UAE.

Most violators deported

Legal action was taken against all those apprehended. Approximately 70 per cent were deported following due legal process, while others were detained pending referral to the relevant authorities for further proceedings.

The most recent large-scale inspection drive was conducted by the ICP in January 2025, during which around 270 inspection campaigns took place nationwide. These efforts led to the apprehension of approximately 6,000 violators, and 93 per cent of those detained were successfully processed for deportation.

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UAE ranked safest country in the world

DUBAI, ABU DHABI, AJMAN RANKED
AMONG SAFEST CITIES GLOBALLY

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The UAE has been named the safest country in the world, according to the Safety Index by Country 2025 Mid-Year, published by global data aggregator Numbeo.

Scoring an impressive 85.2 on the index, the UAE outperformed 147 other nations, reaffirming its status as a global leader in public safety and quality of life.

Following the UAE in the safety rankings are Andorra (84.8), Qatar (84.6), Taiwan (83.0), and Macao (China) (81.8). The Gulf region continues to shine, with Oman securing sixth place (81.4), Saudi Arabia ranking 14th (76.3), and Kuwait placing 38th (67.3).

In the Current Safety Index by City, the UAE stands out for fostering one of the safest and most cohesive societies globally, despite being home to over 200 nationalities.

Five UAE cities in top-six

Abu Dhabi leads the global list of safest cities with a score of 88.8, followed closely by Ajman (85.5), Dubai (83.9), Ras Al Khaimah (83.8), and Sharjah (83.7). This places five UAE cities among the top six safest in the world.

Other cities in the global top ten include Doha, Qatar (84.3),

85.2

UAE's score in the
Safety Index, beating
Andorra at 84.8

Taipei, Taiwan (83.4), Muscat, Oman (81.2), The Hague, Netherlands (80.0), and Tampere, Finland (79.5).

At the other end of the scale, Haiti ranked lowest with a Safety Index score of just 19.0, followed by Papua New Guinea (19.3), Venezuela (19.5), Afghanistan (24.8), and South Africa (25.4).

In a parallel study, the Crime Index by Country 2025 Mid-Year, also released by Numbeo, the UAE was ranked 148th – the lowest position on the index – reflecting a Crime Index of just 14.8. This ranking denotes the lowest crime rate globally, as a lower score indicates a safer country.

In the Current Crime Index by City, the UAE once again stood out, with several cities ranking among those with the lowest crime rates worldwide.

Abu Dhabi was named the safest city globally, recording the lowest Crime Index at just 11.2, followed by Ajman (14.5), Doha (15.7), Dubai (16.1), Ras Al Khaimah (16.2), and Sharjah (16.3).



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